PRE-PURCHASE INSPECTION CHECKLIST

Toyota Land Cruiser FJ60

1980–1987 · FJ60 · 2F 4.2 I6

BOXYTRUCKS

CHECK BEFORE YOU BUY

- [ ] **Rear frame rails first**
  Corsetti calls it the most important check: drop the spare if you have to and look at the rear frame rails. If the frame is rusted through, walk away. IH8MUD members agree the rear channel near the spare is usually the worst frame spot.
- [ ] **The other rust spots**
  Check the windshield gasket corners (peel the rubber back a little), roof drip rails, tailgate hinge areas, inner wheel wells behind the rear seat, front fenders, rockers and rear wheel wells. A missing or uneven mud flap can hide a patched fender, and a magnet finds filler.
- [ ] **Floor under the rear seat**
  IH8MUD buyers' threads add the floor pan under the back seat to the list, along with behind the mud flaps.
- [ ] **Compression test high-mileage trucks**
  On trucks past 200,000 miles, or that have sat or had several owners, do a compression test. Corsetti's numbers for the 2F: around 160–165 psi is excellent, under 120 means caution, under 100 means don't buy, with no more than 10 percent spread between cylinders.
- [ ] **Smog equipment and vacuum lines**
  IH8MUD members call emissions equipment the biggest headache. Check that it's all there, look for cracked or disconnected vacuum hoses, and expect to rebuild the carburetor.
- [ ] **Knuckles, steering and power-steering leaks**
  Sludge at the front knuckles means seals are due. Drive it and feel for wobble, especially on a lifted truck. A shiny, wet driver's-side axle and spring usually means the power-steering box or pump is leaking.
- [ ] **Budget for rubber**
  Hoses, seals, bushings and diaphragms go hard with age, and most will need replacing. One IH8MUD member put catch-up maintenance at several thousand dollars.
- [ ] **Which four-speed?**
  Look for a spacer between the transmission and transfer case. If it's there, it's a post-4/1985 'long' H42, and a five-speed swap is straightforward.

RECALLS TO ASK ABOUT

- [ ] **Steering tie rod can fracture**
  1981 · NHTSA 81V117000
- [ ] **Rear lap belt may not retract**
  1982–1988 · NHTSA 89V155000

IS IT THE REAL THING?

- [ ] **US drivetrain**
  US FJ60s had the 4.2 L 2F carbureted six and a four-speed H41F/H42F, a gearbox Toyota sold only in the US. A five-speed US truck has been converted.

- [ ] **Fuel tank welds can crack**
  1980–1990 · NHTSA 91V110000

- [ ] **Altitude system**
  1981–87 US trucks have High Altitude Compensation emissions gear that works above 3,930 ft. A Weber carb means that system has been bypassed.

- [ ] **Build date split**
  Suspension and other parts change at April 1985 production. Check the build date before ordering springs or a lift kit.

- [ ] **FJ60 vs FJ62**
  The FJ60 is the pre-facelift truck with round headlights and a carburetor. The FJ62 (1988–90) has square headlights, the fuel-injected 3F-E and an automatic.

- [ ] **Diesels**
  BJ60, HJ60 and HJ61 diesels and the FJ61 with the 3F were never sold new in the US. US-titled examples are imports.

NOTES

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